

Seventh Sunday After Pentecost

Dominica Septima Post Pentecosten

TLM propers: true teaching, sanctifying fruit, and sacramental medicine

Proper	TLM text / reference	Scriptural axis	Connection
Introit	<i>Omnes gentes, plaudite manibus</i> (Ps. 46:2)	Universal kingship and praise	The universal King gathers praise before the Gospel warns that religious appearance can counterfeit truth.
Collect	<i>Deus, cuius providentia:</i> remove harms; grant what profits	Providence and purification	Discernment begins by asking God's unfailing providence to remove and supply what the soul cannot master alone.
Epistle	Rom. 6:19–23	Slavery, sanctification, eternal life	Freedom from sin becomes service to God whose present fruit is holiness and whose end is life.
Gradual	<i>Venite, filii, audite me; Accedite ad eum, et illuminamini</i> (Ps. 33:12, 6)	True teaching and illumination	The assembly approaches the Lord to receive his teaching and light, the Mass's positive answer to false prophecy.
Alleluia	<i>Omnes gentes, plaudite manibus</i> (Ps. 46:2)	Royal acclamation	Before the warning, the assembly acclaims the universal King's authority over every teacher and hearer.
Gospel	Matt. 7:15–21	False prophets, trees, fruits, obedience	Moral fruit exposes a life masked by piety; doctrinal truth still requires its proper apostolic and ecclesial norm.
Offertory	<i>Sicut in holocaustis arietum</i> (Dan. 3:40)	Humble sacrifice accepted	The assembly judges no one from above: it first asks that its own offering please God.
Communion	<i>Inclina aurem tuam, accelera, ut eripias me</i> (Ps. 30:3)	Urgent deliverance	Communicants remain petitioners who need deliverance, not spectators who have passed the test.
Postcommunion	<i>Tua nos, Domine, medicinalis operatio</i>	Healing operation	Sacramental medicine frees from perversity and leads the will toward what is right.

Four Senses of Scripture

Thread	Synthesis
Literal	Romans 6 contrasts slavery to sin, shame, and death with service to God, sanctification, and eternal life; Matthew 7 commands vigilance toward false prophets and identifies obedience to the Father's will as decisive fruit.
Allegorical	Christ is the true teacher and obedient Son; the Church bears holy fruit only by his gift. The Gradual's teacher and the Secret's one perfect sacrifice disclose positively what false prophecy and corrupt sacrifice counterfeit.
Moral	Test a life by works rather than costume or slogans, submit one's own conduct to the same judgment, and remember that moral fruit does not by itself establish the truth of doctrine.
Anagogical	The tree's fire and Paul's opposed ends, death and eternal life, reveal final judgment; medicinal grace is offered now so that the sinner may be changed and bear fruit for life.

Core Scriptural Symbols

Thread	Synthesis
Tree	Augustine identifies the tree with the person and its fruit with works. An evil person cannot bear good fruit while remaining evil, yet the tree can be made good through conversion; the image is a diagnosis, not a denial that grace can change the sinner.
Fruit	Romans names fruit unto sanctification, while Matthew points to doing the Father's will. Augustine distinguishes the fruit of the Spirit from impressive practices that can serve as sheep's clothing. This is primarily a moral test; doctrinal truth is judged by revealed faith, not outcomes alone.
Wolf and Clothing	Chrysostom's <i>Homily 23 on Matthew</i> reads the warning as directed especially toward corrupt lives masked by virtue. Clothing can be imitated; sustained action discloses the master actually being served.
Slavery	Paul's stark metaphor removes the fiction of neutral freedom. Chrysostom observes that sin yields shame and death, while God's service already bears holiness even before its promised end is fully seen.
Fire and Medicine	The Gospel's fire names the final seriousness of corrupt fruit; the Postcommunion's medicine names present mercy. Editorially, the Mass places judgment and cure together so that vigilance becomes conversion rather than self-righteous suspicion.

Patristic Exegesis of the Grouped Propers

This Mass orders discernment under Christ's kingship and grace: God calls the nations, teaches his children, exposes false appearance, receives sacrifice through Christ's one perfect offering, and heals the communicant so that obedience can become visible fruit.

Thread	Synthesis
Introit — entrance	<i>Omnes gentes</i> (Ps. 46:2–3) summons every nation before the great King. Editorially, the universal horizon prevents the later warning from shrinking Christian life into suspicious factionalism.

Thread	Synthesis
Collect — petition	The Collect asks unfailing providence to remove all harmful things and grant what profits. Discernment begins as dependence upon God, not confidence in one's private power of detection.
Epistle — apostolic diagnosis	Romans 6:19–23 contrasts masters, fruits, and ends. Chrysostom, <i>Homily 12 on Romans</i> , emphasizes that holiness is already given as fruit, while eternal life is not wages owed for good works but God's gift in Christ.
Gradual — true teaching	<i>Venite, filii, audite me: timorem Domini docebo vos</i> and <i>Accedite ad eum, et illuminamini</i> (Ps. 33:12, 6) answer false prophecy positively: come to the Lord, receive his teaching, and be enlightened. This chant is the Mass's central norm for teachability.
Alleluia — royal acclamation	The Alleluia repeats <i>Omnes gentes</i> (Ps. 46:2). Before the warning is proclaimed, the assembly acclaims the universal King's authority over every teacher and hearer.
Gospel — disclosure and command	Matthew 7:15–21 moves from hidden wolves to visible fruit and finally to the Father's will. Augustine, <i>Sermon on the Mount</i> II.24–25, distinguishes true fruit from show; Chrysostom, <i>Homily 23</i> , targets corrupt life masked as virtue and allows that the sinner can change. Neither makes favorable outcomes alone a sufficient doctrinal test.
Offertory — self-offering	<i>Sicut in holocaustis</i> (Dan. 3:40) asks that a humbled people's offering be accepted. The one discerning others first stands under judgment and offers himself without display.
Secret — Christ's one sacrifice	The Secret says that God perfected the diversity of legal victims in one sacrifice, then asks him to receive and sanctify the servants' offering as he blessed Abel's gifts. This is the altar's answer to counterfeit religion: not performance, but participation in Christ's perfect sacrifice for the salvation of all.
Communion — urgent reception	<i>Inclina aurem tuam, accelera, ut eripias me</i> (Ps. 30:3) keeps the communicant in the posture of need. Discernment has not made the soul its own healer; it receives deliverance.
Postcommunion — continuing effect	<i>Tua nos, Domine, medicinalis operatio</i> asks sacramental action to free the faithful from perversity and lead them to what is right. Grace changes the tree so that obedience and sanctification can become its fruit.

Grouped instruction (editorial synthesis). Praise the universal King, learn from the Lord before judging rival voices, distinguish moral fruit from the separate question of doctrinal truth, submit one's own offering to Christ's one sacrifice, and receive the medicine that alone can heal the root before final judgment.

Exegetical Notes

- “A bad tree cannot bear good fruit” describes the person while remaining in evil; Augustine and Chrysostom both preserve the possibility of conversion rather than weakening “cannot” to “cannot reliably.”
- Matthew's sequence ends with doing the Father's will. Religious speech, apparent success, and even striking works are not substitutes for obedient holiness.
- Moral fruit can expose hypocrisy, but it is not an independent rule for deciding doctrine. The Gradual supplies the positive posture: approach the Lord, receive his teaching, and be enlightened.
- The Secret makes Christ's one perfect sacrifice, rather than the observer's correctness, the center of the Mass's discernment.

Patristic and Sainly Witnesses

Witness	Text / source status	Homiletic use
St. Augustine	Paraphrase — <i>On the Sermon on the Mount</i> II.24–25, 79–84: the person is the tree; works are fruit; ascetic display may be clothing; doing the Father's will is the decisive fruit.	Distinguish real obedience from impressive religious appearance, and direct the test first toward the preacher and hearer.
St. John Chrysostom on Matthew	Paraphrase — <i>Homily 23 on Matthew</i> , 8–9: the warning concerns corrupt lives masked by virtue; an evil person cannot bear good fruit while remaining evil but can change.	Preach vigilance without fatalism: hypocrisy must be exposed, yet grace can make the tree good.
St. John Chrysostom on Romans	Paraphrase — <i>Homily 12 on Romans</i> , on Rom. 6:19–23: sin's fruit is shame and death; holiness is already received, and eternal life remains God's gift rather than earned wages.	Keep moral seriousness inside grace: sanctification is real fruit, not self-salvation.

Homiletic Synthesis

Thread	Synthesis
Proposition	Christian discernment is truthful only when the universal King teaches it, Christ's sacrifice humbles it, and sacramental medicine changes the judge into a tree that bears obedient fruit.
Movement I — gift	God teaches his children, frees them from sin, gives holiness as present fruit, and promises eternal life as gift rather than wages.
Movement II — resistance	Sheep's clothing, pious speech, and judgment of others can conceal a corrupt life; supposed neutrality hides the master actually being served.
Movement III — sacramental conversion	The Offertory submits the discernor to judgment, the Secret joins the offering to Christ's one perfect sacrifice, and Communion receives deliverance and medicine for the root.
Final horizon	Test one influence and one's own response by obedience and holy fruit, verify doctrine by the Church's received faith, and accept present healing before every tree is finally disclosed.

Preaching Applications

- Apply the Gospel first to the preacher and parish: where does religious appearance outrun obedience to the Father's will?
- Test moral fruit patiently, but test teaching by Scripture read in the Church's apostolic faith rather than by popularity or apparent success.
- Bring one entrenched habit to confession and Communion as a sick root needing medicine, not merely a bad appearance needing concealment.

Primary References

- *Missale Romanum* (1962), *Dominica Septima post Pentecosten*; local OCR temporal corpus, Introit through Postcommunion. Latin OCR remains subject to printed-missal verification.
- St. Augustine, *On the Sermon on the Mount*, book II, chs. 24–25, 79–84; trans. William Findlay, NPNF 1.6 (1888), [working public-domain text](#).
- St. John Chrysostom, *Homily 23 on Matthew*, 8–9; trans. George Prevost, rev. M. B. Riddle, NPNF 1.10 (1888), [working public-domain text](#).
- St. John Chrysostom, *Homily 12 on Romans*, on Rom. 6:19–23; trans. J. Walker, J. Sheppard, and H. Browne, rev. George B. Stevens, NPNF 1.11 (1889), [working public-domain text](#).

Full Patristic and Sainly Texts

- St. Augustine, *On the Sermon on the Mount* II.25, 82: “But those are the fruits, to do the will of the Father who is in heaven, in the doing of which He has condescended to exhibit Himself as an example.”
- St. John Chrysostom, *Homily 23 on Matthew*, 8: “For he may indeed change to virtue, being evil; but while continuing in wickedness, he will not bear good fruit.”
- St. John Chrysostom, *Homily 12 on Romans*, on Rom. 6:23: “For he does not say, the wages of good deeds, ‘but the gift of God;’ to show, that it was not of themselves that they were freed.”